

OBSIDIAN GALLERY

Product & Design Constitution

1. Vision

Obsidian Gallery is the definitive digital companion for miniature painters.

It is not simply a productivity tool, a paint inventory, or a gallery.

It is a handcrafted digital workbench that helps hobbyists create, learn, organize, document, share and celebrate their miniature-painting journey.

The application should feel like a natural extension of the physical hobby—not a layer between the painter and their creativity.

Every feature must make miniature painting feel more enjoyable, more rewarding and easier to continue.

2. Product Mission

Every feature should support at least one of these goals:

Help users start painting.

Help users finish projects.

Help users learn new techniques.

Help users remember their processes.

Help users organize their hobby.

Help users preserve their personal painting history.

help users share and bost in their achivements.

Help users feel proud of their progress.

If a feature supports none of these goals, it should not exist.

3. Product Philosophy

Obsidian Gallery is not designed around tasks.

It is designed around the hobby experience.

Users should leave the application feeling inspired to paint—not satisfied that they completed administrative work.

The application should encourage momentum rather than productivity.

Painting always comes first.

Software always comes second.

4. User Experience Philosophy

The interface should feel like sitting at a premium hobby workbench.

Not like operating project management software.

The software should support the hobby without demanding attention.

Every interaction should feel:

calm

tactile

intentional

encouraging

rewarding

educational

The application should never overwhelm users with unnecessary complexity.

5. Core Design Principles

Hobby First

Every decision must improve the painting experience.

Clarity Before Beauty or cognitive load.

Beautiful interfaces that reduce usability are considered failures.

Craft Over Decoration

Every decorative element must reinforce usability, atmosphere or identity.

Decoration without purpose is removed.

Timeless Design

Avoid visual trends.

Design for longevity.

If an element is likely to feel outdated within five years, reconsider it.

Simplicity Wins

Choose the simplest solution that still feels premium.

One Universe

Every screen, asset and interaction should feel as though it was created by the same studio, at the same time.

6. **Visual Language**

The visual identity is inspired by a premium miniature workbench.

The interface combines:

walnut wood

painting and hobby tools

parchment

brass

painted metal

leather

premium paper

subtle workshop tools

Fantasy is present only as atmosphere.

It never dominates usability.

Material Hierarchy

The visual hierarchy should always be:

Current Task

↓

Miniatures

↓

Paint

↓

Content

↓

Interface

↓

Background

The hobby itself is always the visual hero.

Color Philosophy

The interface remains largely neutral.

Strong colors belong to:

miniatures

paints

progress

achievements

UI components should never compete with painted models.

Typography

Typography balances personality with readability.

Decorative typography is reserved for:

page titles

project names

special moments

All functional information should prioritize clarity.

7. Physical Design Language

The application should evoke handcrafted quality—but not simulate a physical object at every level.

Craftsmanship is reserved for meaningful moments.

Tier 1 — Hero Objects

High craftsmanship.

Examples:

Featured Projects

Paint Detail View

Achievement Cards

Curator Notes

Gallery Pieces

These may include:

layered paper

brass pins

parchment

subtle material textures

premium framing

Tier 2 — Workspace Panels

Moderate craftsmanship.

Examples:

statistics

filters

search

section containers

Cleaner materials.

Reduced framing.

Minimal texture.

Tier 3 — Functional UI

Almost invisible.

Examples:

dropdowns

toggles

segmented controls

pagination

chips

tabs

checkboxes

These should prioritize speed and clarity over atmosphere.

The user should interact with them effortlessly.

8. UX Principles

Users should always know:

Where they are.

What they are doing.

What comes next.

Complexity should grow gradually.

Beginners should never feel overwhelmed.

Experts should never feel limited.

Every screen should naturally suggest the next meaningful action.

Reduce cognitive load.

Show information whenever possible.

Never require users to remember information unnecessarily.

Celebrate progress using light gamification.

Achievements should feel earned.

9. Curator Philosophy

The Curator is an experienced painter.

Not a mascot.

Not a tutorial bot.

light comic relief.

The Curator appears only when adding genuine value through:

encouragement

practical advice

milestone recognition

thoughtful observations

The Curator never interrupts workflow.

10. **Asset Guidelines**

Every asset must be:

production-ready

scalable

consistent

premium

readable

elegant

tactile

accessible

Maintain consistency across:

spacing

lighting

perspective

materials

iconography

rendering

illustration style

shadows

textures

corner radii

motion

11. **AI Generation Rules**

Every AI-generated asset must explicitly define:

Objective

Style

Composition

Materials

Lighting

Camera

Color Palette

Texture

Rendering Quality

Consistency Rules

Negative Prompt

All prompts should reference the established Obsidian Gallery design language.

No prompt should reinvent the visual style.

12. Design Review Process

Every proposal should include:

Objective

What problem is being solved?

UX Analysis

How does it improve the user experience?

Design Rationale

Why is this the best solution?

Consistency Review

Does it strengthen the existing Design System?

Scalability Review

Will this solution still work after hundreds of screens and thousands of assets?

Possible Improvements

What could be refined further?

13. Decision Checklist

Before approving any feature, screen or asset, ask:

Does this improve the hobby experience?

Is it easier to understand?

Is it visually calmer?

Does it reduce cognitive load?

Is it consistent with the Design System?

Is it scalable?

Will it still feel modern in five years?

Is there a simpler solution?

Does it inspire someone to paint?

If the answer to any question is "no", iterate before moving forward.

14. What We Never Do

We never overload screens.

We never create unnecessary interaction steps.

We never design around trends.

We never imitate other applications without a strong product reason.

We never decorate at the expense of usability.

We never allow the interface to compete with the miniatures.

We never add features that do not clearly support the product mission.

We never prioritize aesthetics over clarity.

15. The Golden Rule

Obsidian Gallery is a digital workbench where craftsmanship meets clarity.

Every decision should make users feel that they are becoming better miniature painters—not better at using software.